

James Praise

Remote | (+234) 812-654-6251

jameesspraise@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/jamespraise](https://www.linkedin.com/in/jamespraise) | jamespraise.xyz/work | github.com/realjaymes

Professional Summary

GTM Engineer with 5-year focused experience designing and operating revenue and activation systems for B2B and SaaS companies, including small, early-stage teams where I owned onboarding, lifecycle, and growth instrumentation end to end with no separate data or engineering function to lean on. I specialize in building the tracking, automation, and activation infrastructure that turns product usage into a measurable, improvable funnel, not just running campaigns on top of one. My work has lifted trial activation and onboarding conversion by double digits at a bootstrapped SaaS company, contributed to \$10M+ in qualified pipeline, and produced self-built tracking and automation systems used in daily production. More at jamespraise.xyz/work/skylar.

Selected Achievements:

- Rebuilt lifecycle automation and PLG funnel systems at Reform, a bootstrapped SaaS company, lifting trial activation by 34% and onboarding activation by 18% through redesigned onboarding flows and Brevo automation.
- Built a self-contained data and tracking engine from scratch (scraping, enrichment, a self-built MX/SMTP email verifier, scoring, a custom HTML QA/preview tool), run at production scale (409 companies sourced, 271 verified emails enriched in one live run), direct proof of building measurement infrastructure rather than only operating existing tools.
- Improved trial-to-paid conversion by 21% at Reform through a redesigned Pro Plan free trial campaign, validated through structured experimentation rather than a single untested change.
- Led revenue operations at CIL, a B2B technology and training provider selling into sales organizations across Sub-Saharan Africa, generating 1,646 MQLs and 406 SQLs.
- Built automated lead pipelines at Bujeti, generating 1,331 MQLs in 6 months and scaling B2B customers by 500%.

Key Skills

Growth & Activation: Onboarding & Activation Flow Design, Lifecycle Automation, PLG Funnel Design, Growth Experimentation & Hypothesis Testing, User Behavior Analysis, Conversion Rate Optimization, Funnel Instrumentation

Execution: Tracking & Analytics Implementation, Dashboard & Reporting Build, Clay Workflow Building, AI Agent Setup, Automated Data Pipelines, ESP Migration, A/B Testing

Tools: Clay, n8n, Zapier, Claude Code, ChatGPT, Brevo, HubSpot, Salesforce, GA4, Looker Studio, [Apollo.io](https://apollo.io), Apify

Professional Experience

GTM Engineering Consultant | MIA | April 2024 – Present

Marketing In Action (GTME Agency for SaaS, B2B & Product-led)

- Designing and operating AI-enabled growth and activation systems that connect positioning, tracking, automation, and sales execution, from strategy through execution.
- Built a full self-serve data and tracking pipeline (scraping, enrichment, Clay-style personalization, a self-built HTML QA/preview tool) as an internal system, cheap to re-run and built to give visibility into what is working beyond what a dashboard assumes.
- Cumulative impact: \$10M+ in qualified pipeline, plus onboarding, lifecycle, and agentic growth infrastructure built across multiple engagements.

Growth, GTM & Demand Generation Lead | FunnelEnvy | Feb 2024 – April 2026

FunnelEnvy (B2B, Growth Marketing Service Provider)

- Designed and implemented an AI-enabled growth stack combining Clay, n8n, Claude Code, and CRM workflows for B2B SaaS clients.
- Built cross-tool measurement systems connecting HubSpot, GA4, and Looker for funnel visibility across client accounts.
- Launched personalized outbound campaigns across email and LinkedIn, improving reply rates by 27%.

Product Marketing Manager | Reform | Feb 2024 – April 2026

Reform (SaaS, MarTech, bootstrapped)

- Rebuilt onboarding and lifecycle automation across the trial and activation funnel, increasing trial activation by 34% and onboarding activation by 18%.
- Improved trial-to-paid conversion by 21% through a redesigned Pro Plan free trial campaign, tested and validated rather than shipped on instinct.
- Led the ESP migration from Userlist to Brevo including full technical setup (DKIM, DMARC, SPF), list cleanup, and n8n workflow validation, the tracking-and-automation layer underneath the activation numbers above.

Founder & Builder | Marketing In Action Newsletter | Apr 2024 – Present

Marketing In Action (Newsletter, Media & Community Platform)

- Designed and documented GTM automation workflows using Clay, n8n, Zapier, and AI agents.
- Open-sourced 31 marketing agent skills publicly on GitHub, covering GTM, lifecycle, and automation workflows.
- Grew the newsletter to 5,000+ subscribers with 47% average open rate.

Head of Inbound Marketing & Revenue Ops | Distrobird | Feb 2024 – Apr 2024

Distrobird (SaaS, Sales Engagement & Automation Platform)

- Built a bottom-of-funnel inbound system for a sales engagement and automation SaaS product, giving direct experience with how sales teams evaluate and adopt new tools.
- Drove 500,000+ monthly search impressions and 5,000+ organic clicks through programmatic content execution.

Head of Growth & Marketing | Bujeti | Sep 2023 – Feb 2024

Bujeti (SaaS, FinTech, Spend & Expense Management Platform)

- Built B2B lead generation systems combining inbound, outbound, and lifecycle automation.
- Generated 1,331 MQLs in 6 months and scaled B2B customers by 500%.

Demand Generation Manager | Cecure Intelligence Limited | Jun 2022 – Sep 2023

Cecure Intelligence Limited (B2B, Technology & Training Provider selling into sales organizations)

- Led revenue operations across Sub-Saharan Africa, generating 1,646 MQLs and 406 SQLs.
- Secured \$326K in sales velocity and managed \$3.4M+ in open deals.

Marketing, Growth & GTM Roles | Multiple Companies | 2018 – 2022

B2B, SaaS, Ecommerce, Agencies & Service Businesses

Education & Certifications

- MBA, Entrepreneurship & Innovation | Miva Open University (2026) | CGPA: 4.92/5.0
- Product Marketing PMMC™ Certification | Product Marketing Alliance (2025)
- Outbound Automation & AI GTM Engineering Certification | Clay 2025
- BSc. Biochemistry | University of Lagos (2018) | CGPA: 4.46/5.0
- Certifications: Clay (Prompt Engineering, Workflow Automation), HubSpot (SEO, SEM, Content Marketing), Google (Digital Analytics, Display Ads), Agile (Scrum & Kanban)